



Paid Leave for University Staff Employees

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Status Final

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Policy Type [University](#)

Contact Office [Benefits and Leave Center](#)

Oversight Executive

Vice President and Chief Human Resources Officer

Applies To Academic Division and the College at Wise.

Table of Contents

[Policy Statement](#)

1. [Eligibility](#)
2. [Supervisor Approval](#)
3. [Permissible Purposes](#)
4. [Leave Availability](#)
5. [Carry Forward](#)
6. [Cashing-Out Unused Leave](#)
7. [Specific Types of Paid Leave](#)
8. [Paid Holidays](#)
9. [Roles and Responsibilities](#)
10. [Compliance with Policy](#)

[Procedures](#)

Reason for Policy

The University recognizes the needs of University staff employees for time away from work for personal, family, community, and other outside obligations. At the same time, the University has established guidelines for reasonable limits on paid time off for University staff employees, such that each individual's job responsibilities are properly sustained, and all University staff are treated fairly and consistently in matters concerning leave and time away from work.

Definition of Terms

[Leave](#)

Description

An authorized absence from work for various reasons such as vacation, personal illnesses, family illnesses, bereavement, attend to personal business, etc. Most types of leave are paid. However, unpaid leave time may be granted under some circumstances.

Leave Plan Year

Description

Begins with the first day of the pay period which includes January 1 (known as pay period 1) and ends on the last day of the pay period preceding pay period 1 of the following year.

Paid Leave

Description

There are two types of paid leave available to University staff employees:

1. Leave time determined at a variable rate that is based on an employee's years of service, the use of which usually is approved in advance by the employee's supervisor and may be used for **any purpose** including but not limited to vacation, personal and family illness, bereavement, attend to personal business, etc., but requiring no specific justification or explanation by the employee. This is referred to throughout the policy as paid leave.
2. Leave time provided at a predetermined rate, the use of which is approved in advance by the employee's supervisor and must be used for the specific purpose for which it was intended (e.g., Civil and Work-Related Leave, School Assistance and Volunteer Service Leave, etc.).

University Staff Employees (University Staff)

Description

Those salaried, non-faculty employees hired on or after July 1, 2006, and those salaried non-faculty employees and administrative and professional faculty electing to participate in the UVA Human Resources System established by the Board of Visitors under the authority granted by the *Restructuring Act* and the *Management Agreement*. (The term "University Staff Employee" includes all three categories of University staff employees - Operational & Administrative, Managerial & Professional, and Executive & Senior Administrative.)

Management Agreement

Description

The [agreement](#) between the University and the Commonwealth required by Subsection D of § 23.1-1004 of the *Restructuring Act*.

Restructuring Act

Description

The [Restructured Higher Education Financial and Administrative Operations Act](#), Chapter 10 of Title 23.1 of the Code of Virginia.

Policy Statement

The University has established a leave plan for University staff employees (University staff) for time away from work for a variety of reasons. Such leave must be approved and recorded in a manner that protects the interests of both the University and University staff.

1. Eligibility:

All full-time and part-time salaried University staff in benefit-eligible positions who are regularly scheduled to work a minimum of 20 hours to 40 hours per workweek are eligible to receive University staff leave at a rate determined by years of benefit-eligible employment with the University, the Medical Center, or any agency of the Commonwealth of Virginia, up to the established maximum indicated in the chart below. Years of service need not be continuous.

Table A - University Staff Paid Leave Plan			
Benefited Years of Service	Days per Year	Hours per Year	Maximum Annual Leave Carry Forward at Year End**
< 3	22	176	176
3-6	24	192	192
7-9	26	208	208
10-19	28	224	224
20+	30	240	240

** This represents the maximum amount to be cashed out upon termination.

Part-time salaried University staff earn leave at a rate proportionate to their part-time status.

New hires or re-hires will receive University staff leave for the leave plan year in which they are (re)hired at a pro-rated accrual rate based on the date of hire or re-hire.

New or rehired employees with prior state service from other Virginia state agencies may receive credit for their prior service for determining the number of leave days per year at the University if they notify UVA Human Resources in a timely manner as adjustments to the leave accrual will be prospective.

Leave accrued with another Virginia state agency cannot be carried over to the University.

2. Supervisor Approval:

All University staff leave time taken must be approved in advance by the University staff employee's manager and recorded in the applicable human resources management system (HRMS). Such approval shall not be unreasonably withheld. The University staff employee and their manager shall make all reasonable efforts to maintain services during the University staff employee's absence. In the event of an unexpected personal or family illness or other unexpected event that requires an immediate leave of absence, the University staff employee must promptly notify their manager on the first day of the absence or if that is not possible, as soon as practical thereafter.

3. Permissible Purposes:

With manager approval, University staff leave may be used for any purpose, including but not limited to, vacation, personal illnesses, family illnesses, bereavement, community service, to attend to personal business, etc. Use of University staff leave requires no specific justification or explanation by University staff. However, for specific types of paid leave as outlined in [Section 7](#), University staff are required to use the specific leave type for the purposes intended.

4. Leave Availability:

The entire amount of University staff leave will be available for use at the start of each leave plan year providing a University staff employee with maximum flexibility in their use of leave time. University staff leave is earned on a per-pay-period basis. Therefore, if the University staff employee separates from the University during the leave plan year, the time used and the time earned must be reconciled. University staff leave earned but not used will be paid to University staff per policy limit based on length of service (i.e., the monetary value of the remaining leave time as outlined in Table A). University staff leave used but not earned, will be subtracted from the departing University staff employee's final paycheck and/or recouped by the University.

5. Carry Forward:

Earned leave can be carried forward. The maximum number of hours that can be carried forward, into the next leave plan year, is established by the University (See [Table A](#)).

6. Cashing-Out Unused Leave:

At the conclusion of the leave plan year, the applicable HRMS automatically determines the cash-out of unused leave hours at 50% of their value once the amount of leave goes beyond the maximum hours allowed to be carried forward. (See [Table A](#)). To receive this cash-out, University staff must have used a minimum of 10 days total of earned leave. University staff not using the required minimum 10 days of leave, will lose the balance above the maximum carry forward amount. University staff will receive the cash-out payment as taxable income.

Classified staff who convert to University staff may receive a cash-out for unused leave at the conclusion of the leave plan year. Employees must have used a minimum of 10 days of leave which includes annual leave, overtime leave, recognition leave, and compensatory or compensatory special leave during the leave plan year.

7. **Specific Types of Paid Leave:**

In addition to University staff leave that can be used for any purpose as discussed above, the University staff leave plan also includes the following types of paid leave based on a leave plan year except where noted:

- Civil and Work-Related Leave (no limit)
- Compensatory & “Comp Special” Leave (no limit)
- Educational Leave (up to 12 calendar months)
- Emergency/Disaster Leave (up to 80 hours)
- Employee Recognition Leave (up to five paid days)
- Leave to Donate Bone Marrow or Organs (up to 30 workdays)
- Military Leave (up to 21 workdays during the federal fiscal year)
- School Assistance and Volunteer Service Leave (up to 16 hours). University staff who are members of a volunteer fire department or rescue squad may be granted an additional 8 hours of paid leave to be used exclusively for the purpose of providing firefighting and rescue services.

(Detailed information on the paid leave types noted above may be found at [Time Off Options](#).)

The specific paid leave types herein are available for use as needed when approved by a manager and may not be carried forward or cashed out.

8. **Paid Holidays:**

Holidays are awarded separately and are not included in the University staff employee’s leave balance. Official University holidays are posted on the UVA Human Resources [website](#).

9. **Roles and Responsibilities:**

A **University staff employee** is responsible for:

- Seeking leave approval from their manager with reasonable advance notice.
- Planning for continuation of important tasks during the absence.
- Monitoring leave usage.
- Accurately accounting for leave taken through the applicable HRMS.

The **manager** is responsible for:

- Communicating the provisions of this policy to University staff.
- Approving all reasonable requests for leave in a timely manner.
- Maintaining continuation of important tasks in the University staff employee’s absence.

UVA Human Resources is responsible for:

- Providing University staff and managerial guidance on the process for requesting and taking leave.
- Monitoring and administering the leave process.
- Maintaining records and providing reports as necessary.
- Complying with all applicable federal and state laws, as well as University policies.

10. **Compliance with Policy:**

Failure to comply with the requirements of this policy may result in disciplinary action up to and including termination in accordance with relevant University policies.

Direct questions about this policy to the [Benefits and Leave Center](#).

Procedures

[Requesting University Leave](#)

Related Information

[HRM-013: Available Leave Types for University Staff Employees](#)

[HRM-013.02: Paid Parental Leave for University Staff Employees](#)

[HRM-026: Family and Medical Leave](#)

[Short Term Disability Benefits](#)

Major Category [Human Resource Management](#)

Next Scheduled Review Sunday, October 29, 2028

Revision History

Clarified Years of Service, prior state service, and to qualify for a cash-out, must have used 10 days of earned leave 10/29/25; Confirmed 8/26/25; Updated Section 7. Military Leave 8/20/25; Revised 11/16/21; Added Compliance section 7/20/21; Updated 12/27/13; Revised 2/20/12, 1/28/10.

Supersedes Policy Text

HRM-031: Paid Leave for University Staff Employees.

Approved By Executive Vice President & Chief Operating Officer

Approved Date Tuesday, January 26, 2010